

Parkinson's Disease

Who is affected?

- Individuals aged early to mid 60s
- Men are more prone to be affected than women
- Individuals with relatives who have PD
- Environmental exposure to pesticides can be a major cause, thus making people in rural areas susceptible

Neuroscience of PD

In PD, nerve cells or neurons in the brain weaken, get damaged and die. The specific nerve cells affected are the ones that produce Dopamine, a chemical responsible for producing smooth, purposeful movement. A brain region that contains these nerve cells is Substantia Nigra, and has been identified to be affected in patients with PD.